

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at Annalect,

I trained as an architect, and the interest that has run alongside that from the beginning is data - using it to understand what has been built and what could be built better. That is what took me from architecture practice into feasibility and analysis, and then to a Master's Degree in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy, a programme built around using data and technology to improve the decisions made in real estate and construction. The through line has been consistent, which is that I would rather build the analytical tool that answers a question than argue the question without one. Annalect applies that same method commercially, using mathematics, statistics and econometrics to quantify what a client's marketing activity actually achieves, and a team of twenty built around that single question is an unusually direct place to do analytical work.

My Master's Degree in Architecture Computation gave the analytical side of my work its proper depth. I built a predictive property valuation model using ensemble learning across XGBoost, LightGBM, Ridge and CatBoost that finished in the top two per cent of its competition, and a machine learning tool that generates site-specific development recommendations for buildings in Copenhagen by combining financial, social, sustainability and geospatial data, with an interface that lets non-technical stakeholders adjust the impact drivers and weightings themselves. The second of those mattered more to me than the first, because it forced the modelling to survive contact with people who would never open the code. That pairing of a model that performs and an output a client can act on is the substance of this role, and it is the part of my work I have built most deliberately.

During my time in Ramboll Management Consulting's Responsible Business Conduct team I ran human rights due diligence for corporate clients under the UN Guiding Principles and the OECD Guidelines, and in practice a large part of that was data work. I built a fully automated risk assessment system in Excel that consolidated supply chain risk data into a single dashboard which updated salient risks dynamically, an impact assessment tool that scored more than forty risks by severity so the most material ones surfaced first, and a mapping of the supply chains of over twenty critical raw materials under the EU Critical Raw Materials Act. The common task underneath all of it was taking broad and uneven bodies of evidence and structuring them rigorously enough to produce scored, defensible outputs. Your team's projects begin in the same place, since client data and media system exports have to be collected and structured before a model can be fitted to them at all.

Annalect sits inside Omnicom Media Group with the volume of client data that follows from it, and puts a dedicated team on decision support rather than on reporting. That is where I want to keep doing the work I find most worthwhile, which is turning large and awkward bodies of data into something a business can decide on.

Best,

Antonio Carmagnani